

nervous system

sensory impulse

Electrical signal propagated along the nerve fibers (axons) enabling the nerve cells to communicate and to transmit messages within the organism.

spinal ganglion

Bulge of the posterior sensory root of the spinal nerve; it encloses the cell bodies of the neuron sensors.

sensory root

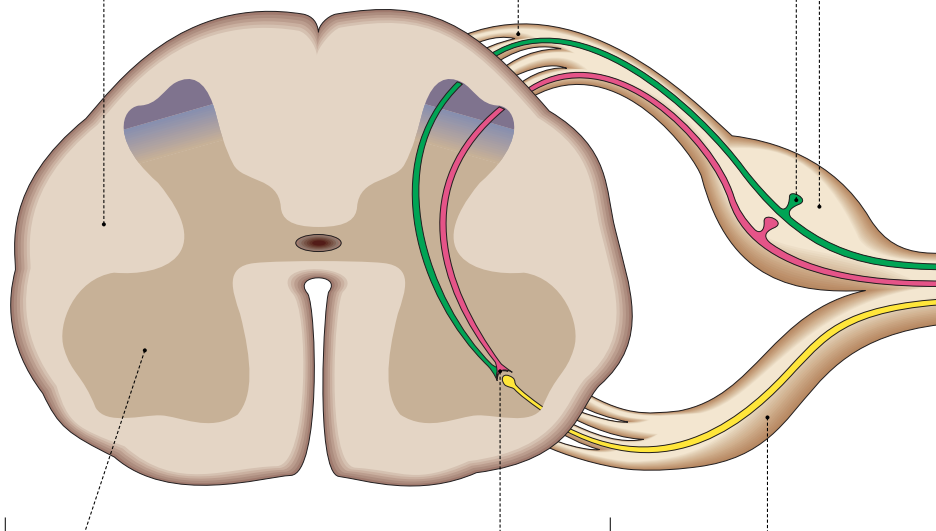
Bundle of sensory nerve fibers (axons) communicating information from the periphery of the body to the spinal cord.

protoneuron

First neuron of the sensory tract; it transmits information from a sensory organ to the spinal cord.

white matter

Section of the spinal cord made up of nerve fibers (axons) and surrounding the gray matter.

**gray matter**

Central part of the spinal cord primarily made of the cell bodies of neurons.

synapse

Contact zone between two neurons through which nerve impulses are transmitted.

motor root

Bundle of motor nerve fibers (axons) communicating information from the spinal cord to the periphery of the body, especially the muscles.

spinal cord

Part of the central nervous system located in the vertebral column; it receives and transmits nerve information and releases the reflexes.